
Breaking Your Lease

Getting out of your lease before the end of the lease term, which is usually twelve months, can be difficult and expensive. You can be held responsible for paying the rent for the remainder of the lease. Find out if there are circumstances that would release you from your obligation. What if you got a job transfer? Had a baby? Some landlords will allow you to break the lease for a fee. Others may allow you to sublet to another tenant. Some landlords will allow you to sign a month-to-month lease. If you sign a month-to-month lease, be aware that the landlord can terminate the lease or raise the rent on short notice. Usually you're still obligated to give written notice of your intention to move out ten to sixty days in advance.